FAMILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE WEEK

Faith Formation for Families • The Congregation at Prayer • Week of November 15–21, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Invocation

In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Introit (see back page)

Memory Verse for the Week — Proverbs 18:10

"The name of the Lord is a strong tower; the righteous man runs into it and is safe."

Daily Readings: LSB p. 299

Sun: Jeremiah 30:1–24; Matthew 26:57–75
Mon: Jeremiah 31:1–17, 23–34; Matthew 27:1–10
Tue: Jeremiah 33:1–22; Matthew 27:11–32
Wed: Jeremiah 37:1–21; Matthew 27:33–56
Thu: Jeremiah 38:1–28; Matthew 27:57–66
Fri: Daniel 1:1–21; Matthew 28:1–20
Sat: Daniel 2:1–23; Revelation 18:1–24

Talk About It This Week

Each day, read the appointed readings (or just one), then ask: *Where did we hear God's Word planted today? What is God teaching us to trust?* Day-by-day questions for younger and older children are in the daily devotion pages (and on the web page).

In Our Prayers This Week (LSB Daily Prayer Themes)

✠ **Sun:** the joy of the resurrection; fruit of faith in all who heard the Word today
✠ **Mon:** our Baptism, callings, and daily work; schools; good government and peace
✠ **Tues:** deliverance from temptation and evil; the addicted and despairing
✠ **Wed:** marriage and family; parents and children; our home and community
✠ **Thurs:** the Church, pastors, teachers, and missionaries; thanksgiving for the Sacrament
✠ **Fri:** the preaching of the cross; the persecuted; the sick and the dying
✠ **Sat:** faithfulness to the end; hearts made ready for the Lord's Day

Hymn of the Week: "Forth in Thy Name, O Lord, I Go" — LSB 854

Forth in Thy name, O Lord, I go, / My daily labor to pursue, / Thee, only Thee, resolved to know / In all I think or speak or do.

Apostles' Creed

Lord's Prayer

Benediction

Let us bless the Lord. **Thanks be to God.**

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE… Gather once a day — at breakfast, supper, or bedtime. Speak the Invocation, say the memory verse together, read the day's readings, talk about them, sing the hymn stanza, pray for the day's theme, and close with the Lord's Prayer and Benediction. Ten minutes is plenty. The seed does the work — "so shall My word be… it shall not return to Me empty" (Isaiah 55:11).

The Twenty-fifth Sunday after Pentecost (Proper 28) November 15, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Introit *Psalm 143:2, 5–6, 10–11; antiphon: v. 1*

Hear my prayer, O LORD; give ear to my pleas for mercy!
In your faithfulness answer me, in your righteousness!
Enter not into judgment with your servant,
for no one living is righteous before you.
I remember the days of old; I meditate on all that you have done;
I ponder the work of your hands.
I stretch out my hands to you;
my soul thirsts for you like a parched land.
Teach me to do your will, for you are my God!
Let your good Spirit lead me on level ground!
For your name's sake, O LORD, preserve my life!
In your righteousness bring my soul out of trouble!
Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.
Hear my prayer, O LORD; give ear to my pleas for mercy!
In your faithfulness answer me, in your righteousness!

Collect of the Day

To be added from the Sunday service folder.

This Sunday's Readings

Zephaniah 1:7–16 · Psalm 90:1–12 · 1 Thessalonians 5:1–11 · Matthew 25:14–30

Gradual *Revelation 7:14b; Psalm 84:5*

These are the ones coming out of the great tribulation.
They have washed their robes and made them white in the blood of the Lamb.
Blessed are those whose strength is in you,
in whose heart are the highways to Zion.

Next Sunday's Readings (Last Sunday (Proper 29))

Ezekiel 34:11–16, 20–24 · Psalm 95:1–7a · 1 Corinthians 15:20–28 · Matthew 25:31–46

Learn by Heart: The First Petition of the Lord's Prayer *LSB p. 323*

"Hallowed be Thy name. What does this mean? God's name is certainly holy in itself, but we pray in this petition that it may be kept holy among us also. How is God's name kept holy? When the Word of God is taught in its truth and purity, and we, as the children of God, also lead holy lives according to it."

THIS WEEK AT HOME: A master leaves on a journey and hands his servants an astonishing amount of money — and then simply trusts them with it. Two of them go to work. The third buries his portion because, he says, he was afraid. Notice what Jesus calls the sin: not losing the money, but refusing to risk anything with it. This week Jeremiah promises a new covenant written on hearts, and Matthew walks all the way to the empty tomb. Ask one another: "What has God handed our family that we have buried because we were afraid?"

Kids in the Divine Service — What is the "Benediction"?

The Benediction (pronounced ben-eh-DIK-shun) is God's blessing given to the congregation through the pastor at the very end of the service. The one we use in the Divine Service is the Aaronic Benediction, from Numbers 6:24–26.

The word comes from the Latin bene, "well," and dicere, "to speak" — God is speaking well to us. He sends us on our way with His blessing after we have received His gifts in Word and Sacrament. That is exactly what this Sunday's Gospel is about: servants sent out with something valuable entrusted to them. God sure does a lot of giving to His people!

Parents: *Show your children the different services in the hymnal and let them find the benediction for each one. Help them locate the Aaronic Benediction and read it together.*

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